AMIDA

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Extracted Text

AMIDA, a god worshipped by the japané, who has many temple credited to him in the island of Japan, of which the principal is at Jedo. The Japanese have fuch a confidence in their laid Andanda, that they hope to train several filing by the frequent invoces into one of the same. One of the figures of this idol is reprefeated at Rome.

Amida (une groge), a principal city of Méopomisnia (Libre Notias) y'_Amanda_ (Polandry); frutated on a high mountain, on the beaches of Afyrits, on the Yrys, you ever receive the Symphian It was taken from the Romans in the time of the emperor Conflars, by Scarye Ring of Perita. The logic is fold to have call him 20.00 men, however, he reduced it to fuch ruin, that the emperor afterwards wept over it. According to Jamaimia Macrellana, the city may reside, like chiff offers were crucified; and the refl, with the soldiers and inhabitants, either put to the foreword or carried into registry, except our billionam landlir, and two orthree more, who, in the dead of the night, escaped through a polsum upterced by the enemy. The inhabits of Zollibs, however, being obliged to leave than own city by Jovians treaty with ACT [97] ACT

Source record

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Amethyſtine / Amianthus

gular, ſemiquinquefid, and perſiſtent: The *corolla* is monopetalous; the border quinquepartite, the loweſt diviſion more expanding: The *ſtamina* conſiſt of two ſlender filaments approximated; the antheræ are ſimple and roundiſh: The *piſtillum* has a four-cleft germen; ſtylus, the ſize of the ſtamina; ſtigmata two, acute: No *corolla*: The *ſeeds* four, gibbous, and ſhorter than the calyx:—There is only one known ſpecies.

This plant is a native of Siberia, from whence the ſeeds were ſent to the imperial garden at Peterſburgh, and thence brought to Britain. It is an annual plant, with an upright ſtalk, which riſes about a foot high. Towards the top it puts forth two or three ſmall lateral branches, garniſhed with ſmall trifid leaves, ſawed on their edges, of a very dark green colour. The flowers appear in June or July, and are produced in ſmall umbels at the extremities of the branches. They are of a fine blue colour, as are alſo the upper part of the branches, and the leaves immediately under the umbel, ſo that they make a fine appearance.

Culture. The ſeeds of the amethyſtea ſhould be ſown in autumn, as they are apt to remain a whole year in the ground if kept till the ſpring. When the plants come up, nothing elſe is neceſſary than to keep them clear of weeds, and to thin them where they are too cloſe. They ought to be ſown where they are to remain, as they do not thrive when tranſplanted.

AMETHYSTINE is applied, in antiquity, to a kind of purple garment dyed of the hue of amethyſt. In this ſenſe amethyſtine differed from *Tyrian* as well as from *hyacinthine* purple, being a kind of medium between both.

AMHAR, or Amhara, a province of Abyſſinia, ſaid to extend 40 leagues from eaſt to weſt. It is conſidered as the moſt noble in the whole empire, both on account of its being the uſual reſidence of the Abyſſinian monarchs, and having a particular dialect different from all the reſt, which, by reaſon of the emperors being brought up in this province, is become the language of the court and of the politer people. Here is the famed rock Amba-geſhen, where the young monarchs were formerly confined. See Amba.

AMHURST (Nicholas), an Engliſh poet and political writer, was born at Marden in Kent, and entered of St John's college, Oxford; from whence he was expelled for irregularity of conduct and libertine principles. Retaining great reſentment againſt the univerſity on this account, he abuſed its learning and diſcipline, and ſome of the moſt reſpectable characters in it, in a poem publiſhed in 1724 called *Oculus Britanniæ*, and in a book intitled *Terræ Filius*. He publiſhed, a Miſcellany of Poems, ſacred and profane; and, The Convocation, a poem in five cantos, which was a ſatire on the Biſhop of Bangor's antagoniſts. But he is beſt known for the ſhare he had in the political paper called *The Craftſman*: though, after having been the drudge of his party for near 20 years, he was as much forgot in the famous compromiſe of 1742 as if he had never been born; and, when he died in that year of a broken heart, was indebted to the charity of his bookſeller for a grave.

AMIANTHUS, or Earth-flax, in natural hiſtory, a fibrous, flexile, elaſtic, mineral ſubſtance, conſiſting of ſhort, abrupt, and interwoven filaments. It is found in Germany, in the ſtrata of iron ore, ſometimes forming veins of an inch in diameter. Its fibres are ſo flexible that cloth has been made of them, and the ſhorter filaments that ſeparate in the waſhing of the ſtone may be made into paper in the common manner. For the method of its preparation for manufacture into cloth, ſee Asbestos. Amicable / Amida.

Amianthus is claſſed by Mr Kirwan in the muriatic genus of earths, becauſe it contains about a fifth part of magneſia. Its other conſtituents are, flint, mild calcareous earth, barytes, clay, and a very ſmall proportion of iron. It is fuſible *per ſe* in a ſtrong heat, and alſo with the common fluxes. It differs from aſbeſtos in containing ſome ponderous earth.

AMICABLE, in a general ſenſe, denotes any thing done in a friendly manner, or to promote peace.

Amicable Benches, in Roman antiquity, were, according to Pitiſcus, lower and leſs honourable ſeats allotted for the *judices pedanei*, or inferior judges, who, upon being admitted of the emperor's council, were dignified by him with the title *amici*.

Amicable Numbers, ſuch as are mutually equal to the ſum of one another's aliquot parts. Thus the numbers 284 and 220 are amicable numbers: for the aliquot parts 1, 2, 4, 5, 10, 11, 20, 22, 44, 55, 110, of 220, are together equal to the other number 284; and the aliquot parts 1, 2, 4, 71, 142, of 284, are together equal to 220.

AMICTUS, in Roman antiquity, was any upper garment worn over the tunica.

Amictus, among eccleſiaſtical writers, the uppermoſt garment anciently worn by the clergy; the other five being the alba, ſingulum, ſtola, manipulus, and planeta. The amictus was a linen garment, of a ſquare figure, covering the head, neck, and ſhoulders, and buckled or claſped before the breaſt. It is ſtill worn by the religious abroad.

AMICULUM, in Roman antiquity, a woman's upper garment, which differed from the pala. It was worn both by matrons and courtezans.

Amicus curiæ, a Law term, to denote a by-ſtander who informs the court of a matter in law that is doubtful or miſtaken.

AMIDA, a god worſhipped by the Japaneſe, who has many temples erected to him in the iſland of Japan, of which the principal is at Jedo. The Japaneſe have ſuch a confidence in their idol Amida, that they hope to attain eternal felicity by the frequent invocation of his name. One of the figures of this idol is repreſented at Rome.

Amida (anc. geog.), a principal city of Meſopotamia (Liber Notitiæ); *Ammæa* (Ptolemy); ſituated on a high mountain, on the borders of Aſſyria, on the Tigris, where it receives the Nymphius.—It was taken from the Romans, in the time of the emperor Conſtans, by Sapores king of Perſia. The ſiege is ſaid to have coſt him 30,000 men; however, he reduced it to ſuch ruin, that the emperor afterwards wept over it. According to Ammianus Marcellinus, the city was raſed; the chief officers were crucified; and the reſt, with the ſoldiers and inhabitants, either put to the ſword or carried into captivity, except our hiſtorian himſelf, and two or three more, who, in the dead of the night, eſcaped through a poſtern unperceived by the enemy. The inhabitants of Niſibis, however, being obliged to leave their own city by Jovian's treaty with

Figure 1: *
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Acroteleutic Act.

ACROTELEUTIC, among eccleſiaſtic writers, an appellation given to any thing added to the end of a pſalm; as the Gloria Patri, or Doxology.

ACROTERIA, in architecture, ſmall pedeſtals, uſually without baſes, anciently placed at the middle or two extremes of pediments or frontiſpieces, ſerving to ſupport the ſtatues, &c. It alſo ſignifies the figures placed as ornaments on the tops of churches, and the ſharp pinnacles that ſtand in ranges about flat buildings with rails and balluſters.

Among ancient phyſicians, it ſignified the larger extremities of the body, as the head, hands, and feet. It has alſo been uſed for the tips of the fingers, and ſometimes for the eminences or proceſſes of bones

ACROTHYMION, from ακρον, *extreme*, and θυμος, *thyme*. A ſort of wart deſcribed by Celſus as hard, rough, with a narrow baſis and broad top; the top is of the colour of thyme, it eaſily ſplits and bleeds. This tumour is alſo called *thymus*.

ACT, in general, denotes the exertion of power; and differs from power, as the effect from the cauſe.

Act, in logic, is particularly underſtood of an operation of the human mind. Thus to diſcern and examine, are acts of the underſtanding; to judge and affirm, are acts of the will. There are voluntary and ſpontaneous acts; the former are produced by the operation of the ſoul, the latter without its privity or participation.

Act, in the univerſities, ſignifies a theſis maintained in public by a candidate for a degree; or to ſhow the capacity and proficiency of a ſtudent. The candidates for a degree of bachelor and maſter of arts are to hold philoſophical Acts; and thoſe for bachelor of divinity, theological Acts, &c. At Oxford, the time when maſters or doctors complete their degrees is alſo called the *act*; which is held with great ſolemnity. At Cambridge, they call it the *commencement*.

Act of Faith, *Auto da Fe*, in the Romiſh church is a ſolemn day held by the inquiſition, for the puniſhment of heretics, and the abſolution of the innocent accuſed*. They uſually contrive the *Auto* to fall on ſome great feſtival, that the execution may paſs with the more awe and regard; at leaſt it is always on a Sunday.

*See Inquiſition.

The Auto da Fe may be called the laſt act of the inquiſitorial tragedy; it is a kind of goal-delivery, appointed as oft as a competent number of priſoners in the inquiſition are convicted of hereſy, either by their own voluntary, or extorted confeſſion, or on the evidence of certain witneſſes. The proceſs is thus: in the morning they are brought into a great hall, where they have certain habits put on, which they are to wear in the proceſſion. The proceſſion is led up by dominican friars; after which come the penitents, ſome with ſan-benitoes, and ſome without, according to the nature of their crimes; being all in black coats without ſleeves, and bare-footed, with a wax candle in their hands. Theſe are followed by the penitents who have narrowly eſcaped being burnt, who over their black coats have flames painted with their points turned downwards, *Fuego revolto*. Next come the negative, and relapſed, who are to be burnt, having flames on their habits pointing upwards. After theſe come ſuch as profeſs doctrines contrary to the faith of Rome, who, beſides flames pointing upwards, have their picture painted on their breaſts, with dogs, ſerpents, and devils, all open-mouthed, about it. Each priſoner is attended with a familiar of the inquiſition; and thoſe to be burnt have alſo a Jeſuit on each hand, who are continually preaching to them to abjure. After the priſoners, comes a troop of familiars on horſeback; and after them the inquiſitors, and other officers of the court, on mules; laſt of all, the inquiſitor-general on a white horſe, led by two men with black hats and green hat-bands. A ſcaffold is erected in the *Terriero de Paio*, big enough for two or three thouſand people; at one end of which are the priſoners, at the other the inquiſitors. After a ſermon made up of encomiums of the inquiſition, and invectives againſt heretics, a prieſt aſcends a deſk near the middle of the ſcaffold, and having taken the abjuration of the penitents, recites the final ſentence of thoſe who are to be put to death; and delivers them to the ſecular arm, earneſtly beſeeching at the ſame time the ſecular power not to touch their blood, or put their lives in danger. The priſoners being thus in the hands of the civil magiſtrate, are preſently loaded with chains, and carried firſt to the ſecular goal, and from thence in an hour or two brought before the civil judge; who, after aſking in what religion they intend to die, pronounces ſentence, on ſuch as declare they die in the communion of the church of Rome, that they ſhall be firſt ſtrangled, and then burnt to aſhes; on ſuch as die in any other faith, that they be burnt alive. Both are immediately carried to the Ribera, the place of execution; where there are as many ſtakes ſet up as there are priſoners to be burnt, with a quantity of dry furze about them. The ſtakes of the profeſſed, that is, ſuch as perſiſt in their hereſy, are about four yards high, having a ſmall board towards the top for the priſoner to be ſeated on. The negative and relapſed being firſt ſtrangled and burnt, the profeſſed mount their ſtakes by a ladder; and the Jeſuits, after ſeveral repeated exhortations to be reconciled to the church, part with them, telling them they leave them to the devil, who is ſtanding at their elbow to receive their ſouls, and carry them with him into the flames of hell. On this a great ſhout is raiſed; and the cry is, Let the dogs *beards be made*; which is done by thruſting flaming furzes faſtened to long poles againſt their faces, till their faces are burnt to a coal, which is accompanied with the loudeſt acclamations of joy. At laſt, fire is ſet to the furze at the bottom of the ſtake, over which the profeſſed are chained ſo high, that the top of the flame ſeldom reaches higher than the ſeat they ſit on; ſo that they rather ſeem roaſted than burnt. There cannot be a more lamentable ſpectacle; the ſufferers continually cry out, while they are able, *Miſericordia per amor de Dios*, "Pity for the love of God!" yet it is beheld by all ſexes, and ages, with tranſports of joy and ſatisfaction.

Act, in dramatic poetry, ſignifies a certain diviſion, or part, of a play, deſigned to give ſome reſpite both to the actors and ſpectators. The Romans were the firſt who divided their theatrical pieces into acts; for no ſuch diviſions appear in the works of the firſt dramatic poets. Their pieces indeed conſiſted of ſeveral parts or diviſions, which they called *protaſis*, *epitaſis*, *cataſtaſis*, and *cataſtrophe*; but theſe diviſions were not marked by any real interruptions on the theatre. Nor does Ariſtotle mention any thing of acts in his Art of Poetry. But, in the time of Horace, all regular and finiſhed pieces were divided into five acts.

Figure 2: *
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